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CYBER SKYLINE

The National Cyber League
A Community Where Cybersecurity Is a Passion

Josh Madar

NCL Spring 2026 Individual Game Scouting Report

Dear Josh Madar,

Thank you for participating in the National Cyber League (NCL) Spring 2026 Season! Our goal is to prepare the next generation of cybersecurity professionals, and your participation is helping achieve that goal.

The NCL was founded in May 2011 to provide an ongoing virtual training ground for collegiate students to develop, practice, and validate their cybersecurity skills in preparation for further learning, industry certifications, and career readiness. The NCL scenario-based challenges were designed around performance-based exam objectives of CompTIA certifications and are aligned to the National Initiative for Cybersecurity Education (NICE) Cybersecurity Workforce Framework published by the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST).

As you look to a future career in cybersecurity, we hope you find this report to be valuable in both validating skills and identifying areas for improvement across the nine NCL skills categories. You can use this NCL Scouting Report to:

- Validate your skills to employers in any job application or professional portfolio;
- Show case your achievements and strengths by including the Score Card view of your performance as part of your résumé or simply sharing the validation link so that others may view the detailed version of this report.

The NCL Spring 2026 Season had 7,520 students/players and 583 faculty/coaches from more than 440 two- and four-year schools & 220 high schools across all 50 U.S. states registered to play. The Individual Game Capture the Flag (CTF) event took place from April 10 through April 12. The Team Game CTF event took place from April 24 through April 26. The games were conducted in real-time for students across the country.

NCL is powered by Cyber Skyline's cloud-based skills evaluation platform. Cyber Skyline hosted the scenario-driven cybersecurity challenges for players to compete and track their progress in real-time.



To validate this report, please access: cyberskyline.com/report/79AK8D0L9AB2

CompTIA. Based on the performance detailed in this NCL Scouting Report, you have earned **11 hours** of Continuing Education Units (CEUs) as approved by CompTIA. You can learn more about the NCL - CompTIA alignment via nationalcyberleague.org/partners.

Congratulations for your participation in the NCL Spring 2026 Individual Game! We hope you will continue to develop your knowledge and skills and make meaningful contributions as part of the Information Security workforce!

Dr. David Zeichick
NCL Commissioner



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CYBER SKYLINE

NATIONAL CYBER LEAGUE SCORE CARD

NCL SPRING 2026 INDIVIDUAL GAME

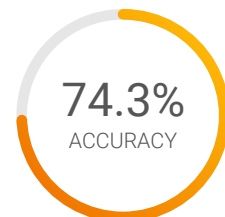
YOUR TOP CATEGORIES

NATIONAL RANK
518TH PLACE
OUT OF 7010
PERCENTILE
93RD

CRYPTOGRAPHY
97TH PERCENTILE

PASSWORD
CRACKING
96TH PERCENTILE

OPEN SOURCE
INTELLIGENCE
93RD PERCENTILE



Average: 62.6%

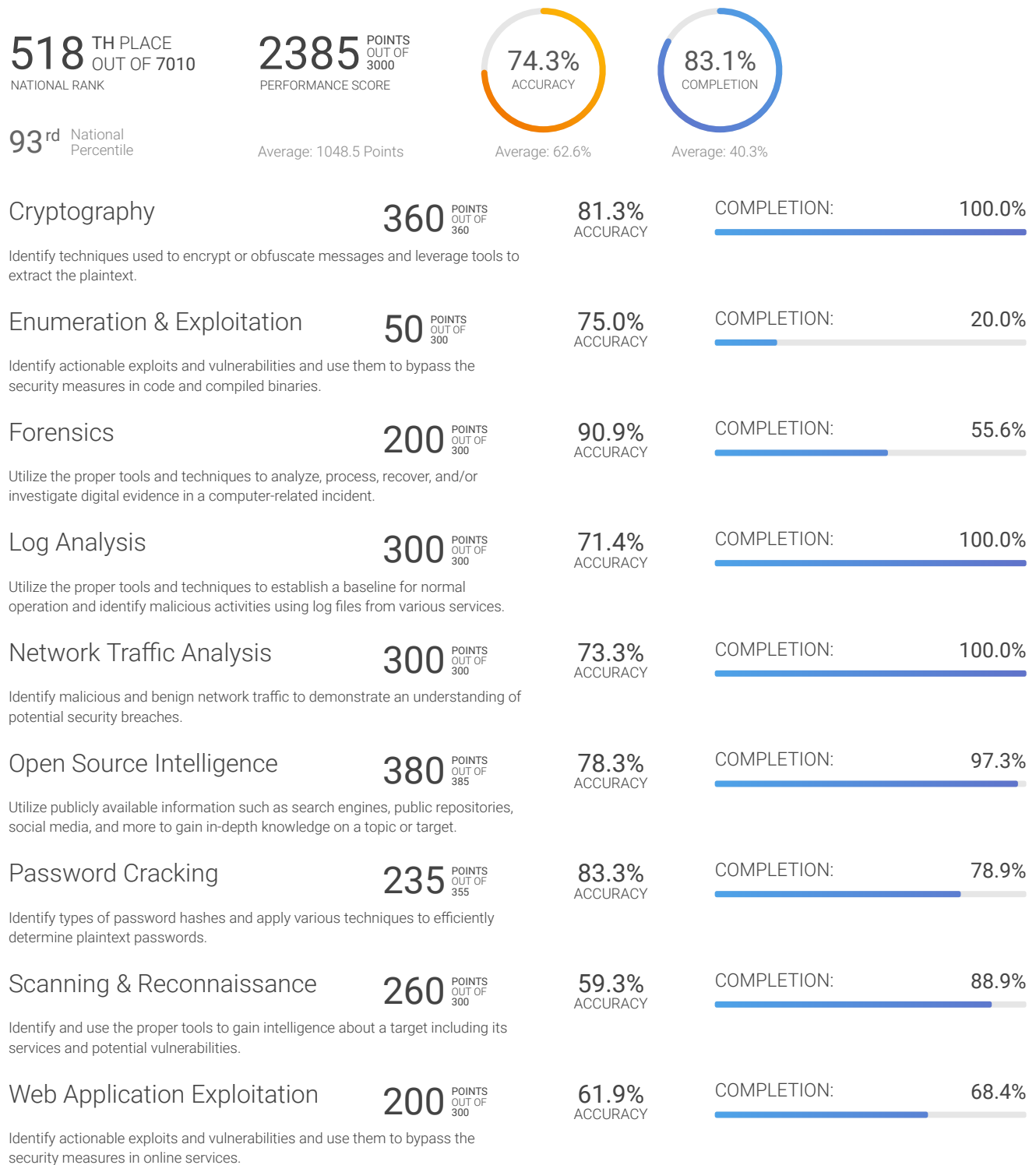
cyberskyline.com/report/79AK8D0L9AB2

Learn more at nationalcyberleague.org



NCL Spring 2026 Individual Game

The NCL Individual Game is designed for student players nationwide to compete in realtime in the categories listed below. The Individual Game evaluates the technical cybersecurity skills of the individual, without the assistance of others.



Note: Survey module (100 points) was excluded from this report.



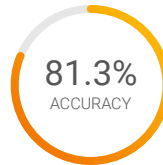


Cryptography Module

Identify techniques used to encrypt or obfuscate messages and leverage tools to extract the plaintext.

231 ST PLACE
OUT OF 7010
NATIONAL RANK

360 POINTS
OUT OF 360
PERFORMANCE SCORE



Average: 64.5%



Average: 48.3%

97th National
Percentile

Average: 143.0 Points

DW (Easy)

50 POINTS
OUT OF 50

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Analyze and obtain the plaintext from text encoded with common number bases.

dorsCrypt (Easy)

50 POINTS
OUT OF 50

66.7%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Manually decode a custom pigpen substitution cipher.

Million Dollar Cat (Medium)

55 POINTS
OUT OF 55

55.6%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Decode baudot telegram messages.

Mirror (Medium)

40 POINTS
OUT OF 40

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Brute force a single byte XOR key to decode a message.

Lottery (Medium)

90 POINTS
OUT OF 90

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Recover the internal seed from an insecurely used pseudo random number generator (PRNG).

Broken Signer (Hard)

75 POINTS
OUT OF 75

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Compute an RSA private key from an unreliable signing oracle and decrypt the flag.



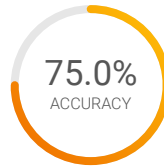


Enumeration & Exploitation Module

Identify actionable exploits and vulnerabilities and use them to bypass the security measures in code and compiled binaries.

1692 ND PLACE
OUT OF 7010
NATIONAL RANK

50 POINTS
OUT OF 300
PERFORMANCE SCORE



Average: 41.0%



Average: 35.8%

76th National
Percentile

Average: 101.6 Points

Chrooted (Easy)

50 POINTS
OUT OF 100

75.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **75.0%**

Research Linux system vulnerabilities and utilize an exploit against a vulnerable version of sudo.

Breads (Medium)

0 POINTS
OUT OF 100

0.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **0.0%**

Reverse-engineer a C++ executable and find a hidden flag.

Liber8eze (Hard)

0 POINTS
OUT OF 100

0.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **0.0%**

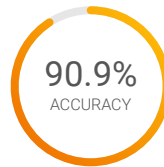
Exploit a running rust binary with a failure point being environment variable injection.

Forensics Module

Utilize the proper tools and techniques to analyze, process, recover, and/or investigate digital evidence in a computer-related incident.

699 TH PLACE
OUT OF 7010
NATIONAL RANK

200 POINTS
OUT OF 300
PERFORMANCE SCORE



Average: 42.8%



Average: 31.4%

91st National
Percentile

Average: 95.5 Points

Fly High (Easy)

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Extract hidden images concatenated from binaries and carve hidden information from images.

Remote Recovery (Medium)

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

83.3%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Use open source tools to recover Windows Remote Desktop bitmap images.

Heap Hunter (Hard)

0 POINTS
OUT OF 100

0.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **0.0%**

Analyze a process dump and recover IoCs related to a potential data exfiltration attack.



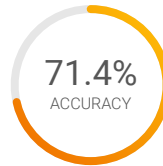


Log Analysis Module

Utilize the proper tools and techniques to establish a baseline for normal operation and identify malicious activities using log files from various services.

553 RD PLACE
OUT OF 7010
NATIONAL RANK

300 POINTS
OUT OF 300
PERFORMANCE SCORE



Average: 49.2%



Average: 48.0%

93rd National
Percentile

Average: 151.5 Points

MCC (Easy)

Parse through simple csv logs using linux cmd line tools.

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

71.4%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Cloudy, with a Trail of Logs (Medium)

Analyze CloudTrail EC2 logs to identify user behaviors and potential IoCs.

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

ADpocalypse (Hard)

Parse through .evtx logs to determine IoCs of a DCSync attack.

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

57.1%
ACCURACY

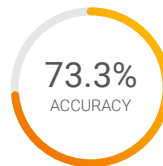
COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Network Traffic Analysis Module

Identify malicious and benign network traffic to demonstrate an understanding of potential security breaches.

509 TH PLACE
OUT OF 7010
NATIONAL RANK

300 POINTS
OUT OF 300
PERFORMANCE SCORE



Average: 39.7%



Average: 40.3%

93rd National
Percentile

Average: 108.1 Points

Parsing DNS (Easy)

Parse packets containing network information and extract relevant fields for investigation.

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

69.2%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Compressed Analysis (Medium)

Identify Man-in-the-Middle (MITM) techniques and conduct an effective post compromise analysis of network traffic.

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

69.2%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Replay (Hard)

Analyze a PCAP with ISO8583 messages and detect a replay attack.

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**



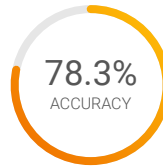


Open Source Intelligence Module

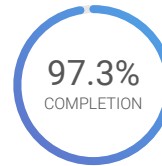
Utilize publicly available information such as search engines, public repositories, social media, and more to gain in-depth knowledge on a topic or target.

491 ST PLACE
OUT OF 7010
NATIONAL RANK

380 POINTS
OUT OF 385
PERFORMANCE SCORE



Average: 60.4%



Average: 71.1%

93rd National
Percentile

Average: 237.4 Points

Rules of Conduct (Easy)

30 POINTS
OUT OF 30

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Introductory challenge on acceptable conduct during NCL.

BSides (Easy)

50 POINTS
OUT OF 55

50.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **85.7%**

Use open source tools to gather information about cybersecurity conferences.

Badge (Easy)

60 POINTS
OUT OF 60

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Perform a reverse image search to identify information about an RFID card reader.

Shipping (Medium)

50 POINTS
OUT OF 50

60.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Use open source tools to collect information about foreign and domestic markets.

Futbol (Medium)

90 POINTS
OUT OF 90

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Analyse historic data leaks to identify patterns and information for decisions.

Ergo Propter Hoc (Hard)

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Trace back malicious actor movements through repositories, usernames, emails, and BTC addresses.



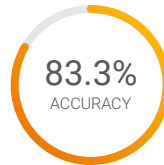


Password Cracking Module

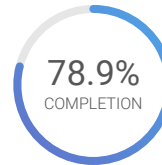
Identify types of password hashes and apply various techniques to efficiently determine plaintext passwords.

323 RD PLACE
OUT OF 7010
NATIONAL RANK

235 POINTS
OUT OF 355
PERFORMANCE SCORE



Average: 70.2%



Average: 37.1%

96th National
Percentile

Average: 100.7 Points

Hashed (Easy)

30 POINTS
OUT OF 30

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Generate hashes for passwords with the MD5, SHA1 and SHA256 hashing algorithms.

Best64 (Easy)

45 POINTS
OUT OF 45

75.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Crack MD5 password hashes using Hashcat's best64 rules.

Upload (Medium)

15 POINTS
OUT OF 45

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **33.3%**

Crack a zip archive and an encrypted text file.

Oph! (Medium)

45 POINTS
OUT OF 45

60.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Crack Windows NTLM password hashes using rainbow tables

Unlocking (Medium)

90 POINTS
OUT OF 90

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Crack Bitlocker user password to open an encrypted Windows drive

Serpens (Hard)

10 POINTS
OUT OF 100

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **33.3%**

Write a custom tool to crack SQLcipher database passwords.



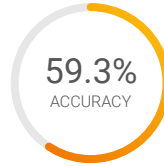


Scanning & Reconnaissance Module

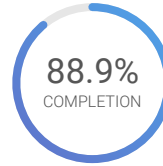
Identify and use the proper tools to gain intelligence about a target including its services and potential vulnerabilities.

778 TH PLACE
OUT OF 7010
NATIONAL RANK

260 POINTS
OUT OF 300
PERFORMANCE SCORE



Average: 44.0%



Average: 38.1%

89th National
Percentile

Average: 116.5 Points

Dig it up (Easy)

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Utilize DNS services to gain information about an organization's Intranet resources.

Scandiego (Medium)

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

46.7%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Use reconnaissance techniques to identify information about avahi services on a remote machine.

Verified (Hard)

60 POINTS
OUT OF 100

57.1%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **66.7%**

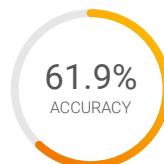
Scan a mail server, enumerate usernames and gain access to an IMAP service.

Web Application Exploitation Module

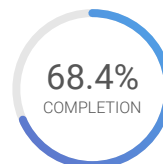
Identify actionable exploits and vulnerabilities and use them to bypass the security measures in online services.

637 TH PLACE
OUT OF 7010
NATIONAL RANK

200 POINTS
OUT OF 300
PERFORMANCE SCORE



Average: 35.0%



Average: 28.9%

91st National
Percentile

Average: 82.7 Points

Typing Racers (Easy)

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

75.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Identify IDOR vulnerabilities to prevent unauthorized access to sensitive data.

Liber8tion File Store (Medium)

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

53.8%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Bypass faulty proxy configurations and exploit a SQL injection to gain access to internal resources.

JS Vault (Hard)

0 POINTS
OUT OF 100

0.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **0.0%**

Deobfuscate javascript to break insecure client-side secret storage.

